

Business Requirements Document

NearBite — Hyperlocal Home-Cook Marketplace

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1. Project Overview

NearBite is a hyperlocal marketplace connecting home cooks with nearby customers. Customers search for home-cooked meals by pincode, view cook profiles and dish photos, and place orders directly via WhatsApp — removing the overhead of a full delivery/payment infrastructure while still enabling local food discovery.

2. Business Objective

- Enable home cooks — especially those without capital for a restaurant or cloud kitchen — to monetize their cooking skills with zero setup cost.
- Give local customers access to authentic, affordable home-cooked food within their neighborhood, using pincode-based search to ensure realistic delivery distance.
- Keep operational overhead minimal by using WhatsApp for ordering instead of building a full in-app payment and delivery logistics system — enabling faster launch and lower maintenance cost.

3. Stakeholders

Stakeholder	Role / Interest	Primary Need
Home Cooks (Sellers)	List dishes, manage profile, receive orders	Easy onboarding, visibility to nearby buyers
Customers (Buyers)	Search, browse, order food	Trust signals (ratings/reviews), simple ordering
Platform Team (Dev)	Build and maintain the platform	Clear scope, low-maintenance architecture

4. Functional Requirements (User Stories)

4.1 Cook-Side

- As a home cook, I want to create a profile with my name, location (pincode), and photo, so customers can identify and trust me.
- As a home cook, I want to upload dishes with photos, price, and description, so customers can browse my offerings.
- As a home cook, I want to receive and view customer ratings/reviews, so I can build credibility over time.

4.2 Customer-Side

- As a customer, I want to search for available home cooks by entering my pincode, so I only see realistic, nearby options.
- As a customer, I want to view a cook's dish list, photos, and ratings, so I can decide what to order.

- As a customer, I want to place an order via WhatsApp directly from a dish listing, so I can complete the order without extra steps.

5. Process Flow — Order Journey

- Step 1: Customer opens NearBite and enters their pincode.
- Step 2: Platform displays a list of home cooks serving that pincode.
- Step 3: Customer selects a cook and views their dish catalogue with photos, prices, and ratings.
- Step 4: Customer selects a dish and taps "Order via WhatsApp."
- Step 5: Platform opens a pre-filled WhatsApp message to the cook with dish name and customer intent.
- Step 6: Cook and customer confirm order details, payment, and delivery directly over WhatsApp.
- Step 7: (Optional, future) Customer leaves a rating/review on the cook's profile.

6. Feature Specifications

6.1 Pincode-Based Search

- Input: 6-digit pincode entered by customer.
- Output: List of cook profiles whose registered pincode matches.
- Edge case: No cooks found for pincode → show empty state message, not a blank screen.

6.2 Cook Profiles & Dish Listings

- Each cook profile includes: name, pincode, profile photo, average rating, and a list of dishes.
- Each dish includes: photo (via Cloudinary), name, price, and short description.

6.3 Ratings & Reviews

- Customers can leave a star rating (1-5) and short text review after an order.
- Average rating displayed on the cook's profile, recalculated on each new review.

6.4 WhatsApp Ordering

- Tapping "Order" generates a WhatsApp deep link pre-filled with dish name and cook's number.
- No in-app payment is processed — all payment/delivery logistics are handled directly between cook and customer.

7. Assumptions & Constraints

- Assumption: Cooks and customers are comfortable coordinating manually over WhatsApp for payment and delivery.
- Assumption: Pincode-level matching is a sufficient proxy for delivery feasibility, without live distance/route calculation.
- Constraint: No in-app payment gateway in current scope — reduces compliance/PCI overhead but limits automated transaction tracking.
- Constraint: Ratings are self-reported post-order and not verified against an actual completed transaction.